



STATUS REPORT

Central African Republic: status report

Edition of 2026-08-16 · 70 systems and instruments tracked, 14 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-14 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/CAF/ledger.csv](#) (70 systems and instruments, 14 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

The Central African Republic's digital state exists mostly as law and appropriation rather than as systems. A [personal data protection law](#) has been in force since January 2024 with no implementing decree and the authority it creates is not established, eighteen months past its statutory deadline; a [cybersecurity law](#) of January 2024 created a national agency that appears nowhere in the 2024, 2025 or 2026 estimates.

The appropriations show the scale: the 2026 programme budget carries [FCFA 4,000,000 for network and information-system security](#) and [FCFA 2,000,000 for digital trust](#), FCFA 6,000,000 for the year for the whole country, against FCFA 1,600,000,000 transferred from the same ministry to the regulator.

Connectivity limits everything else. Internet use is [about 670,000 users, 12.0%, at October 2025](#), and satellite service live since March 2026 costs [about 136% of monthly income per head](#). Fourteen of the rows below are *Not held*.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Central African Internet Exchange	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Creation recorded under highlights for January 2026 in a foreign operator's half-year report
Fourth-generation mobile licensing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A third operator launched 4G in Bangui, completing commercial service at all three

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National fibre backbone	IMPLEMENTED, PARTIAL ↗	Inauguration of the first sections of the backbone and the Congo interconnection
Passive infrastructure licence	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The regulator signed the specification granting the country's first passive-infrastructure licence
Regulator quality-of-service publication website	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The minister stated the regulator had obtained financing for a site publishing operators' quality-of-service data
Satellite broadband service	IMPLEMENTED, ROAMING DEACTIVATED ON NON-HOMOLOGATED KITS ↗	The ministry deactivated roaming on non-homologated kits on traceability and national-security grounds
Twelve-thousand-kilometre fibre commitment	PLANNED ↗	Stated by the minister at the ministry's 2026 orientations ceremony

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Government secure interconnection network	PLANNED ↗	Included as the second axis of the vendor package presented at the May 2026 working meeting
Incumbent operator privatisation	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The minister met the counterparty's operations vice-president, moving a September 2025 memorandum to an operational phase
National Tier III data centre	PLANNED ↗	A vendor delegation met the ministry on a four-axis package whose first axis is a national Tier III data centre

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electricity supply for digital infrastructure	NOT HELD	—

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Technical capacity, workforce and skills	NOT HELD	—

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Cybersecurity and electronic-certification platform	IMPLEMENTED, PER THE ANNOUNCER ↗	Listed in the development bank's delivered scope at the backbone inauguration
National cybersecurity agency	PLANNED ↗	The 2026 estimates and programme budget carry no line, allocation or institution for the agency, a third consecutive year

The backbone has not moved in three years. [935 km of terrestrial and sub-fluvial fibre has been in service on the Bangui-Douala corridor since February 2023](#), with no new kilometrage or route since, while the 2026 estimates give [FCFA 2,000,000 to connect prefecture capitals to Bangui over it](#). Against that the minister has stated a [twelve-thousand-kilometre fibre commitment](#), roughly ten times what is built, with no contract, financing or timetable.

Mobile service is licensed at all three operators and thin on the ground. [The third launched fourth-generation service in Bangui in May 2026](#); a licence is not coverage, and 4G population coverage was measured at 0.3% in 2023. Where one operator is the only network, its failure removes everything at once: at one northern town subscribers reported [no calls, no internet and no mobile money for close to a month, some officials unpaid because salary transfers run over mobile services](#).

Satellite access arrived and was at once conditioned: service has been [live since 16 March 2026 with 450 government kits](#), and in April the ministry [deactivated roaming on kits acquired abroad, on traceability and national-security grounds](#).

Nothing is built for hosting: the [national Tier III data centre remains unbuilt](#), five threads and three sponsors circling it, a 2026 pitch repeating a 2022 target. The only cybersecurity capability delivered rather than announced is a [certification platform in a funder's 2023 delivered scope](#), with no operator or issuance record. Electricity access, the constraint every item here meets, was [17% in 2023](#).

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Government interoperability or data-exchange layer	NOT HELD	—

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Biometric electoral register	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The electoral authority published the definitive electoral list
Biometric passport issuance	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Issuance resumed under a new operator
National digital identity system	PLANNED ↗	Announcement of the system and of a new identification office
National identity card	IMPLEMENTED, LEGAL TARIFF RESTORED AND ACCESS PRICED INFORMALLY ↗	Reporting of religiously targeted extortion at enrolment counters, with the legal tariff formally unchanged

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electricity bill payment over mobile money	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Official launch at Bangui 2026-08-04 under a contract dated October 2025
Gulf-state digital finance and land-banking memorandum	PLANNED ↗	A memorandum signed at Bangui by the minister coordinating major works and strategic investments

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Birth-registration project	PILOTING ↗	A project launched across the region including the country

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Cadastre and land-registry digitisation	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	A Gulf-state memorandum adds land-administration modernisation to the stated programme

Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Civil-service payroll and human-resources system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A funder project paper recorded the payroll clean-up as a project achievement
Sector management information systems	NOT HELD	—

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Ministry-wide planning platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	An official launch under presidential patronage, digitising a whole ministry
Online tax declaration and payment platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Officially launched after adoption and training from January 2025
Public sector digital governance project	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The procurement plan revised, recording two regulator packages as signed and one completed
Treasury single account application	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Modernisation works opened at the central treasury accounting agency
Unified public-services portal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The portal launched as a single entry point for administrative tasks

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
First free public Wi-Fi point	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated by the President during a north-western tour
Universal service fund school and community connectivity	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Effective implementation listed among the regulator's 2026 priorities at the session presenting a draft budget of FCFA 6.2bn

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Local-government digital systems	NOT HELD	—

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Harmonised household living-conditions survey	IMPLEMENTED, FIELD COLLECTION RUNNING ↗	Enumerator teams deployed nationwide, opening six months of collection

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Earth-observation or satellite data	NOT HELD	—

Identity reaches citizens, and it is priced informally. The card's [legal tariff of FCFA 4,500 was restored by interministerial order in June 2025](#) after five years of charging above it; at one prefecture police are reported to serve one religious group first and to demand FCFA 100,000 to 200,000 from another.

The one identity system with a hard number is electoral: a definitive list of [2,398,158 registered voters – 1,641,083 from 2020 plus 757,075 registered in 2025](#) – across 3,910 voting centres. A national digital identity system was announced in [November 2025](#) at US\$13m, unifying existing biometric and civil-registration databases, on a [2027 to 2032 window](#), procurement still ahead.

Government platforms exist and publish no use: a [unified public-services portal launched in December 2025](#) with no usage figure; a [ministry-wide planning platform digitised one whole ministry](#) at a cost stated nowhere; and the [online tax platform has published no filing figure since its March 2025 launch](#). The only state system with a delivered result is a [payroll clean-up removing more than 2,000 ghost workers](#). The state electricity utility's bills became [payable over one operator's mobile-money service on 2026-08-04](#), with no tariff, transaction fee or volume disclosed.

Below that the layer is missing: no interoperability or data-exchange framework is held, the minister's own January 2026 statement being that state information systems remain heterogeneous; no health, education or agriculture system is held as a system, only appropriations of [FCFA 6,000,000 for education and FCFA 2,000,000 for agriculture](#); and nothing on local-government systems, in a year when municipal and regional elections were held for the first time in about 36 years.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Cybersecurity and cybercrime law	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Voted by acclamation 2024-01-25, with promulgation reported as imminent
Public procurement code	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted by acclamation 2025-12-11, replacing a 2008 law

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National development plan 2024-2028	IMPLEMENTED ↗	The governing framework since 2024, with an investors' round table in September 2025
Public finances digitalisation plan 2025-2027	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Presented by the finance minister 2025-06-18; a costed operational plan due in April 2025 not published
Universal service fund	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Effective implementation named among the regulator's 2026 priorities at its draft-budget session

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
CEMAC interoperable QR-code standard	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the regional central bank and the payments body at Douala under an April 2026 regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Regional digital integration programme accession	PLANNED ↗	The minister met a development-bank delegation on the country's participation; no financing agreement recorded

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Regulator spectrum-monitoring and quality-of-service systems	IMPLEMENTED, ONE PACKAGE DELIVERED ↗	A spectrum contract signed 2024-10-06 and completed 2025-06-19; a quality-of-service package signed 2024-10-15 with no completion date printed

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Data protection authority	PLANNED ↗	A twelve-month statutory deadline expired in January 2025 with no establishment recorded
Loi n. 24.001 on personal data protection	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Promulgated January 2024; no implementing decree found
National cybersecurity strategy, response team and operations centre	NOT HELD	—

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Civil-status modernisation programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A steering committee validated the implementing partner's 2025 activities 2026-02-20
Digital collection of administrative fees	PILOTING ↗	An implementation workshop 14 to 16 April 2026 with three pilot ministries

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National open government data portal or catalogue	NOT HELD	—

Two statutes are in force and neither has produced an institution. The [data protection law of January 2024](#) has no [implementing decree](#) and its authority, which would wield a sanction ceiling of 5% of pre-tax turnover, is [not established](#). The [cybersecurity and cybercrime law of January 2024](#), carrying [six to ten year sentences and fines of FCFA 5m to 10m](#), is unchanged in text and was named by a commentator in July 2026 as the instrument now used against online content; its own text is not held. No national cybersecurity strategy, response team or operations centre exists: the only evidence is a 2022 appraisal recording all three absent and a score of 3.6 on a cybersecurity index against 29.5 for the region.

A [new public procurement code](#) was adopted in December 2025, replacing a 2008 law, with a [FCFA 10,000,000 publicity threshold](#) and a [5% preference margin for national and regional firms](#); promulgation is not recorded and the enacted text is not held.

The universal service fund is a rule without an outcome. Provided for by a 2018 law and financed by a [2% levy on operators' previous-year turnover](#), it is still not operational, with effective implementation targeted for 2026, and has never published an amount collected or a balance in the seven years since the levy took effect.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AI system deployed in state service delivery	NOT HELD	—
National AI policy, strategy or regulation	NOT HELD	—

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Bitcoin as legal tender	DISCONTINUED ↗	Parliament amended the April 2022 cryptocurrency law, revoking legal-tender status

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Presidential meme coin	IMPLEMENTED, NO MEASURABLE DOMESTIC UPTAKE ↗	Announced by the President; it passed US\$900m market capitalisation over the launch weekend and then lost more than 75% of its value
State-sponsored token	DISCONTINUED ↗	The project announced it would not continue in its original form, the website already offline
Tokenised land concessions	IMPLEMENTED ↗	A count of concession sales: 122 plots at a fixed price of about US\$314 each

US / hyperscaler activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Incumbent-operator privatisation and recapitalisation	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	The minister met the counterparty's operations vice-president; the government declared the September 2025 memorandum in its operational phase

China activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Vendor four-axis e-government programme	PLANNED ↗	A working meeting setting four axes: a national data centre, five microwave-relay sites, unified telephony and videoconferencing, and a secure police radio network

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
India-linked technology activity	NOT HELD	—

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital finance and land-banking memorandum	PLANNED ↗	A memorandum signed at Bangui

No national AI policy, strategy, decree or bill appears anywhere in the base, and no AI system is recorded as deployed in state service delivery; the one AI-in-government item held is an analytical finding that a presidential land certificate was likely machine-generated. What has moved is a request: the communications council [asked the regulator for tighter subscriber identification and for cooperation with international platforms on closing accounts](#), acknowledging that its competence covers media professionals. No instrument was adopted.

The most consequential technology record here is cryptocurrency. Bitcoin's [legal-tender status was revoked in March 2023](#); a state-sponsored token [ended with 10% of its 210-million target sold and under EUR 2m raised](#); and a [presidential meme coin passed US\\$900m market capitalisation over its launch weekend](#), then lost more than 75% of its value and remains the payment rail for [tokenised land concessions](#), [122 plots sold for about US\\$38,308 by November 2025](#). No evidence is held that its revenues were declared as public income.

The sector cannot be sized: no revenue, employment or operator disclosure is held, the regulator publishes nothing, and no startup funding figure exists.

Inclusion and capacity

Digital divides

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Satellite retail service affordability	IMPLEMENTED, WITH NON-HOMOLOGATED KITS SUSPENDED ↗	Roaming on illegally imported kits suspended six weeks after commercial launch

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital literacy programme	NOT HELD	—

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital skills or training programme	NOT HELD	—

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Research capacity	NOT HELD	—

Skills, literacy and research carry no programme at all: three years of budget estimates contain no digital-literacy line, and the only research-adjacent appropriation on record is [FCFA 20,000,000 to digitise university diplomas](#) — the one figure this section can point to for what should be its core subject. The digital-divides table above rests on a single row, and neither literacy nor training and skills nor research institutions carries a status beyond *Not held*.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Regional digital integration programme	PLANNED ↗	The minister met a development-bank delegation; no amount, instrument or date committed

MoUs and other agreements

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Dormant data-centre memorandum	IN DEVELOPMENT, DORMANT ↗	Signed January 2025 and never advanced to contract

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Administration telephone arrears to the incumbent operator	PLANNED, PROPOSED STAGE ONLY ↗	Carried unchanged at FCFA 250m in the 2026 framework
Customs system deployment	PLANNED, PROPOSED STAGE ONLY ↗	A single 2026 activity for deployment to third-terminal sites
Digital development agency transfer	PLANNED, PROPOSED STAGE ONLY ↗	Split in the 2026 framework into an urban fibre-loop activity and a salary-arrears activity
Private-invoice transfers in the digital ministry vote	PLANNED, PROPOSED STAGE ONLY ↗	Two named private-invoice lines carried in the 2026 medium-term framework
Regulator support transfer	PLANNED, PROPOSED STAGE ONLY ↗	Carried at FCFA 1.6bn in the 2026 medium-term framework

The 2026 state budget sets [resources at FCFA 368bn against expenditure of FCFA 396.35bn, a deficit of FCFA 28bn, own resources up 11.18% and public investment down 2.06%](#). Inside it, the digital lines are small and their purposes often unstated. Two [private-invoice transfer lines in the digital ministry's vote carry FCFA 1,000,000,000 and FCFA 500,000,000 for 2026](#), the first doubled in a year, with no purpose stated in any year; together they are 21 times the ministry's entire investment title. The [digital development agency's transfer is FCFA 300,000,000 for urban optical loops plus FCFA 118,000,000 to clear six months of unpaid 2024 salaries](#). The state also budgets [FCFA 250,000,000 of telephone arrears to its own incumbent for a third year](#) while negotiating that operator's privatisation.

The largest 2026 digital line outside the ministry's vote is revenue collection: [FCFA 420,000,000 for customs system deployment](#).

None of these figures is enacted: every figure held is proposed or revised, all three enacted finance laws being image-only scans, and no outturn is held at any grain because the quarterly execution series is published entirely as page images whose digits do not extract.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Electricity supply for digital infrastructure	a utility annual report or tariff schedule, an electricity-project implementation status report, or a commissioning record for any of the planned mini-grids	not yet probed
Technical capacity, workforce and skills	an ICT workforce or skills assessment, a regulator or ministry capacity audit, or an operating record for the university digital training centre listed as delivered in 2023	not yet probed
National cybersecurity strategy, response team and operations centre	the promulgated cybersecurity law text, an agency establishment decree, or a national cybersecurity strategy	not yet probed
National open government data portal or catalogue	a government open-data portal with a dated dataset listing, or the data governance policy the public finances plan names and does not price	not yet probed
Government interoperability or data-exchange layer	a decree or agency framework creating a government service bus or interoperability standard	not yet probed
Sector management information systems	a health-ministry or education-ministry deployment record, or a contract award or donor project document for any sector system	not yet probed
Independent measurement of internet penetration	a regulator statistical bulletin, a statistics-institute survey module, or an operator-reported subscriber series filed with the regulator	not yet probed
Earth-observation or satellite data	any earth-observation agreement, geospatial data platform, national mapping programme or satellite-imagery procurement	not yet probed
Local-government digital systems	any commune-level platform, local revenue system, or territorial-administration programme document for the councils elected in December 2025	not yet probed
National AI policy, strategy or regulation	a published national AI strategy, a decree or bill on automated decision-making, or a continental AI-strategy accession instrument naming the country	not yet probed
AI system deployed in state service delivery	a procurement notice, contract, pilot announcement or ministry statement naming a deployed system and a vendor	not yet probed
Startup funding, accelerator cohort or ecosystem figure	a funding-round announcement, an incubator cohort list, or a tracker country figure	not yet probed
ICT sector size, revenue, employment or operator financials	a regulator annual report or observatory, a national-accounts ICT line, or operator segment disclosure	not yet probed
India-linked technology activity	a training-centre record, an export-bank line of credit for digital infrastructure, or an Indian vendor contract	not yet probed
Digital literacy programme	any dated ministry, regulator or donor document naming a digital-literacy programme with a scope or a budget line	not yet probed
Digital skills or training programme	a named programme primary with enrolment or funding figures, or a regional programme project document once signed	not yet probed
Research capacity	a university, statistics-institute or donor research document	not yet probed
Enacted appropriation for any year	a text-extractable copy of any of the three enacted finance laws, at line grain	not yet probed
Budget outturn at any grain	a text-extractable quarterly execution report, or a settlement law later than 2019	not yet probed

Fourteen instrument rows carry no reliable statement, and that proportion is itself the finding. Four are systems no document establishes: a cybersecurity strategy, response team and operations centre; a government interoperability layer; sector management information systems; and local-government digital systems for the councils elected in December 2025.

Four are capability absences: no technical capacity or workforce record at any date, no digital literacy programme, no digital skills programme, no research capacity. Three are technology absences: no AI policy, no AI system deployed in state service delivery, no India-linked activity.

The last three are why this report's own figures cannot be tested: no independent measurement of internet penetration, every figure tracing to one international estimate redistributed by three intermediaries; no enacted appropriation for any year; and no budget outturn at any grain. For the last two the documents exist as page images, so availability is not the constraint and extraction is. Each row is in `gaps.csv` with what would settle it; none has yet been probed.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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